Marketing Strategy for FitBite Healthy Snack

Course: Principles of Marketing

1. Product and Marketing Orientation

FitBite is a healthy snack made from familiar and nutritious local ingredients, including dates, peanuts, oats, and sesame seeds. It is packaged in a small, convenient package that is easy to carry and is specifically designed to meet the needs of busy students and employees.

The core value offered by FitBite lies in combining great taste, convenience, and affordability. The product is priced at only 1,000 Sudanese pounds. The exchange process involves customers paying money in return for energy, nutrition, and taste, while the company receives revenue as well as valuable customer feedback.

The company adopts the Marketing Concept, which focuses on understanding and satisfying customers' needs and wants. This orientation was selected because FitBite was developed after identifying real customer needs, represented by a customer persona named Ahmed, a student who needs an affordable and nutritious snack. The product was then designed to satisfy this need.

This approach differs from other marketing orientations. The Production Concept focuses primarily on efficiency and distribution, which may overlook customer preferences. The Product Concept emphasizes quality and performance, which can sometimes lead to excessively high prices. Meanwhile, the Selling Concept relies heavily on aggressive promotion and sales efforts rather than building long-term customer loyalty.

2. Competitive Analysis

Competition in the snack market can be divided into two main categories.

A. Direct Competitors

Direct competitors are products that offer similar benefits and serve the same purpose as FitBite, such as energy bars and snack products. Examples include Tiger Bar, Break Bar, Abu Auf, and Datto.

B. Indirect Competitors

Indirect competitors are alternative products that customers may purchase to satisfy their hunger. These include Royal biscuits, Captain Majid chips, Cadbury chocolate, bakery products, and fresh fruits.

Competitive Advantage

FitBite has three main competitive advantages:

- Familiar Local Ingredients: The product uses ingredients that are familiar and popular among Sudanese consumers.
- Convenient Packaging: Its small and practical package makes it easy to carry and consume anywhere.
- Affordable Price: FitBite is offered at a competitive price that is significantly lower than the prices of many competing products. While competing products may cost approximately 1,500 Sudanese pounds, FitBite costs only 1,000 Sudanese pounds.

These advantages position FitBite as an affordable, convenient, and appealing snack option.

3. Market Segmentation

The market is divided into four main segments based on demographic, geographic, psychographic, and behavioral characteristics.

A. Demographic Segmentation

FitBite targets consumers aged 16 to 35, particularly students and employees with low to middle incomes.

B. Geographic Segmentation

The initial target areas are Khartoum, Omdurman, and Bahri, particularly locations near universities, gyms, and other places frequently visited by the target customers.

C. Psychographic Segmentation

The product targets individuals who prefer convenient, familiar, and affordable snacks that fit their active lifestyles.

D. Behavioral Segmentation

FitBite targets consumers who purchase snacks regularly, need quick refreshments during breaks, and are attracted to discounts, special offers, and multipack deals.

4. Target Market

FitBite's target market is divided into two main groups.

A. Primary Target Market

The primary target market consists of university students aged 18 to 30 who need affordable, tasty, and convenient snacks during their studies and daily activities.

B. Secondary Target Market

The secondary target market includes gym members and busy professionals who need a quick snack during their daily routines.

Customer Persona: Ahmed

Ahmed is a 22-year-old university student with a limited budget. He needs an affordable, tasty, and nutritious snack that he can easily carry in his backpack and eat between lectures.

The target market is attractive for several reasons. Students often purchase snacks regularly, making them a potential source of repeat sales. They can also be reached through relatively affordable marketing channels, including TikTok, Instagram, and word-of-mouth recommendations among university students.

The assumption that this market represents more than 40% of the total market would need to be verified through market research before being presented as a confirmed statistic.

5. Marketing Mix (The 4 Ps): Building the Marketing Mix for FitBite Healthy Snack

The four Ps—Product, Price, Place, and Promotion—work together to attract students and employees and create competitive value.

A. Product

- Made from familiar local ingredients: dates, peanuts, oats, and sesame seeds.
- Small, convenient packaging that includes product information, expiry date, and allergen warnings.
- The brand reflects an active and convenient lifestyle.
- Marketing message: “Great Taste, Convenient Energy, Ready for Your Day!”

B. Price

- Uses a market penetration pricing strategy to attract customers quickly.
- Introductory price: 1,000 Sudanese pounds per package.
- Estimated competitor price: 1,500 Sudanese pounds.
- Student discounts and discounts on multipack purchases.
- Goal: encourage first-time purchases and build market share.

C. Place

- Local grocery stores and supermarkets.
- University cafeterias.
- Gyms and fitness centers.
- Direct online sales through Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok.

D. Promotion

- Advertising through social media platforms.
- Distributing free samples at universities and gyms.
- Collaborating with influencers to review and promote the product.
- Promotional posters and materials at points of sale.
- Encouraging satisfied customers to recommend the product to friends and family.

6. Customer Relationship Management (CRM)

A. Customer Satisfaction

We provide good quality and affordable prices to keep our customers happy.

B. Repeat Purchases

We encourage customers to buy FitBite regularly through special offers.

C. Customer Loyalty

We build trust with customers through a loyalty program: Buy 9 packages and get 1 free.

D. Customer Feedback

We listen to customers' opinions to improve our product and introduce new flavors.